

» AFTER

Records of undercover operations were destroyed at the end of the war, making it impossible for historians to glean facts from fiction.

LINCOLN'S ASSASSINATION

Confederate secret files were burned on the instructions of Secretary of State Judah P. Benjamin before the [fall of Richmond in 1865](#). Speculation about what these documents may have contained has been especially intense because of possible links between Confederate covert operations and the [assassination of President Lincoln](#). His assassin, John Wilkes Booth, had met with Confederate secret agents in Canada, and one theory is that Booth was tasked with a mission to **kidnap the president**, but instead he assassinated him.

POSTWAR HONOR

Individuals were honored after the war for spying for the Union. Despite the **perceived value of such work**, it took two decades for the U.S. Army's Military Intelligence Division to be created, and not until 1903 did the **Army integrate its intelligence unit** into a general staff.



UNION MEDAL FOR
SPYING